QP CODE: 25901846

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATIONS, April 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Skill Development Components (SDC) - MG2SDCBTX100 - PRINCIPLES OF MANAGEMENT

Time: 2 Hours **Max. Marks: 70**

PART - A

Very Short Answers. Answer **any 12** questions. Each question carries **1 mark**.

1. **Planning premises** are the assumptions and forecasts about future conditions under which plans are expected to operate.
2. **Autocratic leadership** is a leadership style in which the leader makes decisions alone and expects subordinates to follow instructions without participation.
3. **Two characteristics of motivation:**
    - It is a psychological process.
    - It directs human behaviour toward goals.
4. **Span of control** means the number of subordinates who can be effectively supervised by one manager.
5. **Two challenges of corporate governance:**
    - Lack of transparency
    - Conflict of interest
6. **Three levels of management:**
    - Top-level management
    - Middle-level management
    - Lower-level / supervisory management
7. **Strategic plan** is a long-term plan prepared to achieve overall organisational goals and objectives.
8. **Any two activities of personnel management:**
    - Recruitment
    - Training and development
9. **CSR** means **Corporate Social Responsibility**.
10. **Examples:**

- On-the-job training: Apprenticeship / job rotation
- Off-the-job training: Classroom lecture / workshop

11. **First step in decision-making:** Identification of the problem.
12. **Two elements/tools of scientific management:**

- Time study
- Motion study

13. **Leadership** is the ability to influence and guide people to work willingly toward achieving organisational goals.
14. **Two characteristics of controlling:**

- It is a continuous process.
- It ensures performance according to plans.

15. **Selection** is the process of choosing the most suitable candidate from among the applicants for a job.

PART - B

Short Essay Questions. Answer **any four** questions. Each question carries **7 marks**

16. Nature and Characteristics of Management

Management is the process of planning, organising, staffing, directing and controlling resources to achieve organisational objectives efficiently and effectively.

Characteristics:

- Goal-oriented
- Universal process
- Continuous process
- Group activity
- Dynamic function
- Intangible force
- Multidisciplinary
- Decision-making process

17. Delegation of Authority

Delegation means assigning responsibility and authority to subordinates for performing specific tasks.

Elements:

- Assignment of duties
- Granting of authority
- Creation of accountability

Importance:

- Reduces workload of managers
- Develops employee skills
- Ensures quick decision-making
- Improves efficiency

18. Staffing and Its Characteristics

Staffing is the managerial function concerned with recruitment, selection, training, development and placement of employees.

Characteristics:

- Human resource function
- Continuous process
- Concerned with right person for right job
- Includes training and development
- Essential at all levels

19. Major Unethical Practices in Business

- Corruption and bribery
- False advertising
- Tax evasion
- Exploitation of workers
- Environmental pollution
- Insider trading
- Misleading financial statements

20. Functions of Management

- **Planning** – deciding in advance what to do
- **Organising** – arranging resources
- **Staffing** – managing human resources
- **Directing** – guiding employees
- **Controlling** – measuring and correcting performance

21. Change Management

Change management refers to systematic efforts to deal with changes in organisational structure, technology, policies or people.

Need:

- Technological advancement
- Competition
- Market changes
- Employee development

Steps:

- Identify need for change
- Plan change
- Implement
- Monitor and review

PART - C

Essay Questions. Answer **any Two** question. The question carries **15 marks**

22. Define organising and explain the characteristics and importance of organising.

Organising:
Organising is the process of identifying and grouping activities, assigning duties, delegating authority, and establishing relationships among employees to achieve organisational objectives effectively.

Characteristics of Organising:

- Division of work into manageable activities
- Coordination among different departments and individuals
- Establishment of authority and responsibility relationships
- Delegation of authority to subordinates
- Formation of a clear organisational structure
- Achievement-oriented process
- Continuous and dynamic process
- Facilitates cooperation among employees
- Defines reporting relationships
- Ensures optimum utilisation of resources

Importance of Organising:

- Facilitates achievement of organisational objectives
- Promotes specialization and efficiency
- Avoids duplication of work
- Clarifies authority and responsibility
- Ensures effective coordination
- Helps in optimum use of resources
- Improves communication within the organisation
- Encourages teamwork and cooperation
- Facilitates effective control and supervision
- Enables adaptation to changes
- Assists in employee development
- Enhances productivity and profitability

23. Explain in detail the managerial skills classified by Robert L. Katz. Analyse how the requirement of these skills varies across different levels of management.

Robert L. Katz classified managerial skills into three categories:

1. Technical Skills
2. Human Skills
3. Conceptual Skills

Technical Skills:

- Ability to use specialised knowledge, methods, and techniques
- Involves proficiency in a specific field
- Includes knowledge of tools, procedures, and processes
- Essential for performing operational activities efficiently
- Examples: accounting, production techniques, computer operations

Importance:

- Helps in solving technical problems
- Ensures efficient task performance
- Improves operational efficiency

Human Skills:

- Ability to work effectively with people
- Includes communication, motivation, leadership, and coordination
- Helps managers understand employee behaviour
- Essential for maintaining good interpersonal relationships

Importance:

- Promotes teamwork and cooperation
- Reduces conflicts
- Improves employee morale and motivation
- Ensures effective communication

Conceptual Skills:

- Ability to understand the organisation as a whole
- Helps in analysing complex situations
- Involves strategic thinking and decision-making
- Enables managers to relate organisational activities to objectives

Importance:

- Helps in long-term planning
- Facilitates policy formulation
- Assists in solving organisational problems
- Promotes innovation and strategic vision

Variation of Skills Across Management Levels:

Top-Level Management:

- Requires high conceptual skills
- Human skills are also essential
- Technical skills are comparatively less important
- Responsible for strategic decisions and policy formulation

Middle-Level Management:

- Requires balanced technical, human, and conceptual skills
- Acts as a link between top and lower management
- Coordinates departmental activities

Lower-Level Management:

- Requires high technical skills
- Human skills are important for supervising workers
- Conceptual skills are comparatively less required
- Focuses on day-to-day operations

24. **Discuss the concept of motivation and analyse McGregor's Theory of Motivation.**

Motivation: Motivation is the process of stimulating people to act in order to achieve organisational and personal goals. It is an internal force that encourages employees to perform better and achieve desired objectives.

Features of Motivation:

- Psychological and continuous process
- Goal-oriented activity
- Influences human behaviour
- Improves efficiency and productivity
- Can be financial and non-financial
- Helps satisfy employee needs

Importance of Motivation:

- Increases employee performance
- Improves morale and job satisfaction
- Reduces absenteeism and labour turnover
- Promotes teamwork and cooperation
- Enhances organisational productivity
- Encourages innovation and creativity

McGregor's Theory of Motivation:

Douglas McGregor developed two assumptions about human behaviour:

1. Theory X
2. Theory Y

Theory X:
Theory X assumes that employees are naturally lazy and dislike work.

Assumptions:

- Employees avoid responsibility
- Workers dislike work
- Employees require strict supervision
- People prefer security over ambition
- Workers are motivated mainly by money
- Punishment and control are necessary

Characteristics:

- Authoritarian style of management
- Centralised decision-making
- Close supervision
- Limited employee participation

Theory Y:
Theory Y assumes that employees are self-motivated and enjoy work.

Assumptions:

- Work is natural like play or rest
- Employees accept responsibility
- Workers are capable of self-direction
- Employees seek opportunities for growth
- Creativity and innovation exist among workers
- Participation improves commitment

Characteristics:

- Democratic leadership style
- Decentralised decision-making
- Employee participation encouraged
- Focus on self-control and self-motivation